Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Friday, 16 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Rain	Rain	Light rain	Light drizzle
17° 10°	15° 8°	13° 9°	12° 8°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The Duke and Duchess of Sussex have made their first official public appearance since moving back to the UK.**
Harry and Meghan are in Nottingham, taking part in a series of events linked to their charitable work. It's their first joint engagement since returning to Britain.
ROYALS · UK

2 **Fifty people have been arrested in a major crime investigation following a fatal crash on the A66.**
The arrests are part of a wider operation targeting organised crime, launched after the deadly incident on the A66. Police are continuing their enquiries.
CRIME · UK

3 **King Charles has praised Wales's 'sense of belonging' as he officially opened the Senedd in Cardiff.**
The monarch and Queen Camilla were in the Welsh capital to open the Senedd's seventh term. It was a day of pomp and ceremony.
ROYALS · UK

4 **The UK government is threatening to ban Eritreans over the country's refusal to co-operate with migrant returns.**
The Home Secretary said she wouldn't hesitate to impose measures on nations that don't help with migrant return policies. It's a tough stance from the government.
POLITICS · UK

5 **Another man has admitted raping a woman who was drugged by her husband over two decades.**
The husband is accused of inviting 13 other men to abuse his wife at their family home in Stockport. This latest admission adds to a truly shocking case.
CRIME · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Good news for fans of 'Girls' – Lena Dunham's hit series is set to return for a limited run on HBO!**

Ten years after the series finale, the gang is getting back together. This time, they'll be exploring the 'milestone of turning forty'.

ON AIR – Are you excited to see what the 'Girls' are up to ten years on? What do you think turning forty will mean for them?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Marvel fans, get ready to meet a new Welsh villain, complete with a Cardiff accent, in the upcoming Disney+ series 'VisionQuest'!**

Lauren Morais will be playing Lisa Molinari, a brand new character joining the Marvel universe. It's great to hear a proper Welsh voice in a big superhero show!

ON AIR – What do you think of a Marvel villain having a Cardiff accent? Are you excited to see a bit of Wales in the MCU?

TV · COMING UP

3 **Robert Pattinson is starring in a new film, 'Primetime', exploring how hunting predators became hit TV.**

The actor portrays the real-life host of the American TV show 'To Catch a Predator'. It sounds like a fascinating, and perhaps unsettling, look at true crime on screen.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of true crime on TV? What do you think about shows that delve into the darker side of human nature?

FILM · COMING UP

4 **Hollywood hardman Ray Winstone has been charming locals in a Welsh market town while filming his new action comedy.**

Winstone plays an ex-SAS operative, Alan 'Razor' Sharp, in 'Danger Money'. It sounds like he's making quite an impression off-screen too!

ON AIR – Who's your favourite British actor who always plays the tough guy? And have you ever spotted a celebrity filming near you?

FILM · COMING UP

5 **Everton striker Thierno Barry has opened up about the emotional video he was initially scared to post.**

He's explained why he eventually chose to share the powerful footage from a training session. It sounds like a very personal and brave decision.

ON AIR – Have you ever shared something online that you were nervous about? What makes you decide to hit 'post'?

FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Aston Villa have rewritten the record books, thrashing Turkish side Fenerbahce six-nil in Europe!**

It was Villa's biggest ever win in a European competition, with Nicolas Jackson and Ross Barkley both scoring twice. What a night for the Villans!

ON AIR — What's the most memorable European night you've seen for a British club? Was it a record-breaker?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Liverpool's summer signing Bradley Barcola scored his first senior hat-trick, as they beat LASK 6-3 in the Champions League.**

It was a brilliant performance from Barcola, who also got his first goals for the Reds. Two wins from two in Europe for Liverpool!

ON AIR — Who's been the most impressive new signing in the Premier League so far this season? Has anyone surprised you?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Great Britain's women have struck gold in the team pursuit at the Track Cycling World Championships in Shanghai!**

Erin Boothman, Anna Morris, Millie Couzens and Josie Knight put in a fantastic performance. Another brilliant medal for Team GB!

ON AIR — What's your favourite cycling event to watch? Do you prefer the track or the road?

CYCLING · UK

4 **And there's more gold for Great Britain, as Matthew Bostock won the men's scratch race in Shanghai!**

Bostock put in a commanding performance at the Track Cycling World Championships. It's been a great championships for the British team.

ON AIR — Do you think British cycling is set for another golden era? Who are the stars to watch out for?

CYCLING · UK

5 **Northern Ireland's Tom McKibbin is just one shot off the lead at the DP World India Championship, with Rory McIlroy also in contention.**

It's been a weather-disrupted opening day, but McKibbin is looking strong. McIlroy is three shots further back, but anything can happen!

ON AIR — Who's your pick to win the DP World India Championship? And what's your favourite golf course in the world?

GOLF · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A survey says most of us have a 'signature dish' we bring out whenever guests come round.**
Chilli, lasagne and a roast top the list. Very few of us, it turns out, have a second dish ready if the first goes wrong.

2 **Community 'little libraries' — swap-a-book boxes on the street — are popping up in more neighbourhoods.**
The unwritten rule is take one, leave one. The most-swapped genre, organisers say, is the holiday thriller.

3 **Brits spend an average of 38 minutes a day deciding what to watch — and 12 of those are spent scrolling Netflix.**
'Watch-paralysis' has its own subreddit. Streamers are quietly experimenting with 'shuffle' buttons that just play something.

4 **One in three of us has had a 'sleep divorce' — sleeping in a separate bed from our partner.**
Reasons: snoring (45%), different schedules (30%), restless legs, and one bizarre 12% who say their partner 'talks to the cat in their sleep'.

5 **Board game cafés are booming on UK high streets.**
Owners say the biggest sellers are the quick, daft games — not the four-hour epics. The most common cause of fallouts remains the rules of a certain word game.

6 **British baby names are getting shorter again — three- and four-letter names are dominating the registrar.**
Top picks this year: Noa, Ezra, Ada and Bo. Long, multi-syllable Victorian names like Theodora are sliding back down the chart.

7 **A study suggests humming or singing badly in the car genuinely lifts your mood.**
Researchers link it to deep breathing and a small dose of joy. Fellow drivers at the lights may not share the enthusiasm.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **59% of us have a name for THIS that only our family understands.**

ANSWER: THE REMOTE CONTROL — OURS IS APPARENTLY CALLED ALL SORTS.

Q **Asked the most stressful part of a group meal out, the top answer was THIS.**

ANSWER: WORKING OUT HOW TO SPLIT THE BILL.

TALK TOPIC

- **A study claims we all have one chore we secretly enjoy.**
  Which household job do you actually find satisfying — and which one would you happily never do again?
- **Apparently most people have a 'lucky' item they take to big occasions.**
  What's yours — and has it ever actually worked?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There's a planet-sized ball of carbon nicknamed by astronomers as a possible 'diamond' — a burnt-out star whose core may have crystallised. It's about 50 light-years from Earth.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** NASA has confirmed the International Space Station now carries a small kettle, after British astronauts repeatedly complained there was 'no proper way to make a brew' in orbit.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.4 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.4 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A teaspoon of neutron star would weigh billions of tonnes on Earth.
- Sharks can sense a single drop of blood in an Olympic-sized swimming pool's worth of water.
- The word 'avocado' comes from an old Aztec word, and so does 'chocolate'.
- Crocodiles can't stick their tongues out.
- The UK's oldest known pub claims a history going back over a thousand years.
- A cockroach can live for a week or so without its head.
- More than half the bones in your body are in your hands and feet.
- Saturn isn't the only planet with rings — Jupiter, Uranus and Neptune have them too, just fainter.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES FRI 16 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 289 of the year, 76 days left in 2026. Today Air Force Day (Bulgaria); Boss's Day (United States); Christian feast day: Balderic (Baudry) of Monfaucon; Christian feast day: Bertrand of Comminges. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1928 — Ann Morgan Guilbert, American actress (died 2016)
- 1958 — Tim Robbins, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1960 — Bob Mould, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1947 — Bob Weir, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2026)
- 1959 — Gary Kemp, English singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actor
- 1973 — David Unsworth, English footballer and manager
- 1962 — Flea, Australian-American bass player, songwriter, and actor
- 1969 — Wendy Wilson, American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1970 — Canadian Prime Minister Pierre Trudeau invokes the War Measures Act during the October Crisis.
- 1995 — The Million Man March takes place in Washington, D.C. About 837,000 attend.
- 1998 — Former Chilean dictator Augusto Pinochet is arrested in London on a murder extradition warrant.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1962 — Cuban Missile Crisis begins: U.S. President John F. Kennedy is informed of photos taken on October 14 by a U-2 showing nuclear missiles (the crisis will last for 13 days starting from this point).
- 1949 — The Greek Communist Party announces a "temporary cease-fire", thus ending the Greek Civil War.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1975 — The Australian Coalition sparks a constitutional crisis when they vote to defer funding for the government's annual budget.
- 1978 — Cardinal Karol Wojtyła is elected to the papacy as Pope John Paul II, he becomes the first non-Italian pontiff since 1523.
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1946 — Nuremberg trials: Ten defendants found guilty by the International Military Tribunal are executed by hanging.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SAT 17 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 290 of the year, 75 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anstrudis; Christian feast day: Catervus; Christian feast day: Ethelred and Ethelberht; Christian feast day: Florentius of Orange. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — Margot Kidder, Canadian-American actress (died 2018)
- 1946 — Michael Hossack, American drummer (died 2012)
- 1977 — Alimi Ballard, American actor and producer
- 1992 — Jacob Artist, American actor, singer, and dancer
- 1960 — Bernie Nolan, Irish singer (died 2013)
- 1937 — Paxton Whitehead, English actor (died 2023)
- 1940 — Jim Smith, English footballer and manager (died 2019)
- 1977 — Bryan Bertino, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1966 — The 23rd Street Fire in New York City kills 12 firefighters.
- 1977 — The hijacked Lufthansa Flight 181 lands in Mogadishu. The remaining hostages are later rescued.
- 2017 — Syrian civil war: The Syrian Democratic Forces (SDF) capture the last foothold of the Islamic State of Iraq and the Levant (ISIL) in Raqqa, marking the end of the Battle of Raqqa.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2004 — A fire that lasted over 15 hours destroyed almost one third of the East Tower of the Parque Central Urban Complex in Caracas, Venezuela.
- 1965 — The 1964–65 New York World's Fair closes after two years and more than 51 million attendees.

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10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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